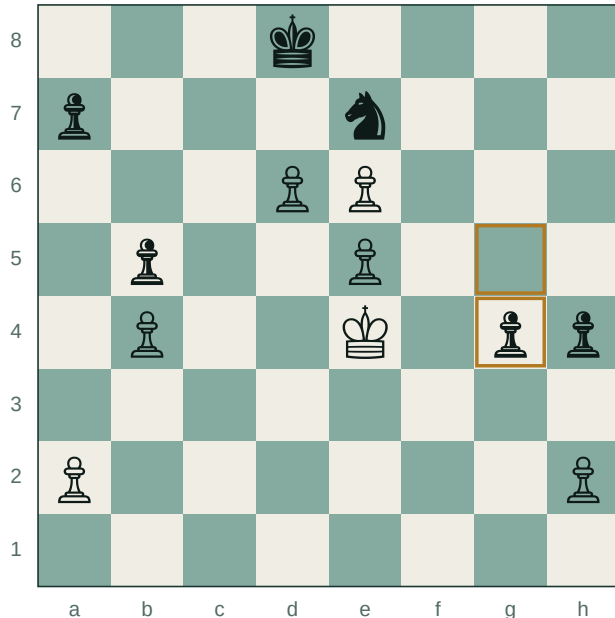


Advanced-pawn tactics: White, move 42

Advanced-pawn tactics

White to move



Previous move: 41...g4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

42. dxe7+ Kxe7 43. Kf4 Kxe6 44. Kxg4

42.dxe7+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the knight on e7. Recorded reply: **42...Kxe7**.

43.Kf4 The king moves from e4 to f4. Recorded reply: **43...Kxe6**.

44.Kxg4 The king captures the pawn on g4.

At the end, nominal material is White 4 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on d8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.